

The Dhāraṇī Mantra of the Blessed One Amitābha

Bhagavān Amitābha Dhāraṇī Mantra · Toh 677 · Derge Kangyur

བཅའོ་ལྷན་འདས་འདོད་པ་གཟེ་གཟུངས་སྒྲུས།

Toh 677 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as Tsé dang yeshé dpag tu mé pa'i nyingpo, in Sanskrit as the Bhagavān Amitābha Dhāraṇī Mantra, and in English as "The Essence of Immeasurable Life and Primordial Wisdom." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on a mantra dedicated to Amitābha, the buddha of immeasurable light and life, whose recitation is said to purify even the gravest karmic obscurations accumulated over vast stretches of time. The text presents the mantra itself together with a brief account of its merits, promising that even the four root downfalls can be completely purified through its recitation. It was translated from Sanskrit into Tibetan by the Indian scholar Puṇyasambhava and the Tibetan translator Patshab Nyima Drakpa.

Here ends the dhāraṇī called "The Essence of Immeasurable Life and Primordial Wisdom."

Translated by the Indian scholar Puṇyasambhava and the Tibetan translator Patshab Nyima Drakpa.

In Sanskrit: Bhagavān Amitābha Dhāraṇī Mantra.

In Tibetan: The dhāraṇī mantra of the Blessed One Amitābha.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha Amitābha.

Tadyathā: Amite, Amitodbhave, Amitasambhave, Amitavikrānta-kāre, Amita-gagana-kīrti-kare, Sarva-kleśa-kṣayaṃ-kari, Svāhā.

The virtue of this dhāraṇī is as follows. Even the karmic obscurations accumulated over a hundred thousand aeons will be exhausted if one recites it three times. If one recites it twenty-one times, even the four root downfalls (pārājikas) will be completely purified, and wholesome roots equivalent to those planted in the presence of a thousand buddhas will be created. One should hold the Blessed One Amitābha in mind with recollection.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Mahīduhike, Svāhā.

Whether illness has arisen in the body, or whether one is wasting away from a chronic sickness within, if one recites it twenty-one times and fans the person with a fan, they will become free from illness.

As soon as that dhāraṇī mantra was spoken, all those in the retinue rejoiced and offered heartfelt praise for what the Blessed One had declared.

Here ends the dhāraṇī of the Blessed One Amitābha.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase translated as "four root downfalls" renders the Tibetan term for the four pārājikas, the most serious class of monastic transgressions causing expulsion from the Saṅgha; in the Mahāyāna context here, these may refer analogously to the root bodhisattva downfalls rather than strictly Vinaya pārājikas, though the text does not specify.

The mantra syllables "Mahīduhike" in the secondary dhāraṇī formula are unclear in meaning and may represent a corrupted or abbreviated Sanskrit phrase; no emendation has been made to the body of the translation.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.